

JORDAN RIVERA

Backend Java Developer
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Platform engineer with **10+ years** building resilient document-generation pipelines, layout engines, and developer-facing template systems. Specialised in high-throughput PDF rendering, semantic authoring DSLs, and turning brittle production-ops scripts into typed, snapshot-tested libraries that scale.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Senior Platform Engineer 2024-Present

Northwind Systems

Led the reusable document-generation platform serving billing, hiring, and reporting flows across 8 product teams. Reduced template maintenance time by 70% by retiring per-team PDF scripts in favour of one canonical engine.

Software Engineer 2021-2024

BrightLeaf Labs

Built backend services and production document rendering pipelines processing 2M+ documents per month. Drove the migration from iText to a custom layout engine, eliminating licensing risk and cutting p99 render latency from 1.4s to 380ms.

Backend Engineer 2019-2021

Helix Print Co

Maintained a high-volume invoice-printing service (15M PDFs/year) and authored the compliance test harness that gated every template change.

PROJECTS

GraphCompose

Declarative Java PDF layout engine. Semantic DSL, slot-based templates, snapshot testing. Powers production CV / invoice / proposal pipelines for hiring tools and billing systems. (Open source)

Template Studio

Internal tool for evaluating CV, proposal, and invoice output across 14 design presets. PNG diffing, side-by-side layout, baseline freezing.

LayoutLint

Static analyser that flags fragile authoring patterns (deeply nested rows, untyped offsets, implicit page breaks) before they ship to production.

ChromeForge

Editorial-magazine document toolkit built on GraphCompose: cinematic covers, pull quotes, multi-column flow, sidebar callouts.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science 2021. Distinction. Thesis: Composable layout primitives for deterministic document rendering.

University of Manchester

BSc Software Engineering 2019. First-class honours. Specialisation in compilers and static analysis.

Imperial College London

Oracle Java Certification 2023. Java 17 platform deep-dive: records, sealed types, pattern matching, virtual threads.

Professional track

KEY SKILLS

• Java 21	• Kotlin	• Groovy	• Python
• SQL	• PDFBox	• Apache POI (DOCX/XLSX)	• iText
• PostScript	• ICC colour profiles	• font metrics	• Custom DSL design
• semantic layout trees	• pagination	• snapshot testing	• visual regression
• Maven	• Gradle	• GitHub Actions	• JitPack
• Docker	• JMH benchmarking	• JUnit 5	• AssertJ
• PDFBox-based PNG diff	• layout-graph snapshots	• mutation testing (Pitest)	• Maven Central
• Sonatype OSSRH	• GPG signing	• JitPack	• semantic versioning discipline

ADDITIONAL

Languages: English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Spanish (Basic)

Work Eligibility: Eligible to work in the UK and the EU

Open Source: Maintainer of GraphCompose. Regular contributor to PDFBox issue triage.

Speaking: JVM Summit 2024, Devovx UK 2025 — both on declarative document layout.

References available upon request.